

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 4

Chapter 13: वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity)

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	13 — वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. National-olympiad traps: count मात्रा by adding each VOWEL's value (ह्रस्व 1, दीर्घ 2, प्लुत 3) — never count letters/consonants; a syllable is गुरु if its vowel is दीर्घ (long by nature) OR a short vowel is closed by a conjunct/अनुस्वार/विसर्ग or word-final consonant (long by position) — forgetting position-guru is the classic slip; अनुस्वार and विसर्ग add no मात्रा of their own yet still make the preceding short vowel गुरु; ए ऐ ओ औ are all दीर्घ (2 मात्रा), never short; sandhi conserves vowel-time only sometimes (अ+आ→आ drops 3→2); मात्रा counts duration not pitch/weight; वर्ण = sound/letter not caste; रैति singular vs रुवन्ति plural is number not tense. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. Count the total मात्रा in the word कमलानि (vowels: अ in क, अ in म, आ in ला, इ in नि).

(A) 4 मात्रा

(B) 6 मात्रा

(C) 5 मात्रा (1 + 1 + 2 + 1)

(D) 3 मात्रा (one per syllable)

2. Scan the word कमलम् into its laghu (ल) / guru (ग) pattern syllable by syllable (क + म + लम्).

(A) ल ल ल — every short अ stays light regardless of what follows

(B) ग ल ल — only the first syllable is heavy (C) ग ग ग — every syllable of the word is heavy

(D) ल ल ग — क is light, म is light, the final लम् is heavy because short अ is closed by the word-final म्

3. In the word पुस्तकम् the first syllable is पु, carrying short उ immediately before the conjunct स्त. Classify पु for weight and give the precise reason.

- (A) गुरु (heavy) — the short उ is closed by the following conjunct स्त, so it is heavy by position
 (B) लघु (light) — a syllable built on short उ is always light
 (C) गुरु (heavy) — because उ is itself a long vowel
 (D) लघु (light) — conjuncts after a vowel never change its weight

4. Which single property guarantees a syllable is गुरु PURELY by nature (so that nothing about the following sound can change the verdict)?

- (A) A conjunct consonant follows its short vowel
 (B) Its vowel is दीर्घ (long), e.g. आ, ई, ऊ, ए, ऐ, ओ, औ
 (C) An अनुस्वार follows its short vowel (D) A विसर्ग follows its short vowel

5. Count the total मात्रा in विद्यालयः (vowels: इ in वि, आ in द्या, अ in ल, अ in यः).

- (A) 4 मात्रा (B) 5 मात्रा (1 + 2 + 1 + 1)
 (C) 6 मात्रा (D) 8 मात्रा (count the consonants too)

6. The word शिवः has two syllables, शि (short इ) and वः (short अ before विसर्ग). Give the correct laghu/guru pattern AND the total मात्रा.

- (A) ल ल, and 2 मात्रा total (B) ग ग, and 4 मात्रा total
 (C) ल ग, and 3 मात्रा total (the विसर्ग adds one) (D) ल ग, and 2 मात्रा total

7. A student says: 'The syllable न्ति in शान्तिः must be guru because it has a conjunct.' Examine the syllable न्ति (the cluster न्त joins to short इ). Is the student right?

- (A) Yes — any conjunct anywhere in the syllable makes it guru
 (B) No — short vowels can never be guru under any rule
 (C) Yes — and the conjunct also adds 2 मात्रा
 (D) No — the conjunct न्त belongs to the ONSET of न्ति; its short इ is closed only by the following विसर्ग, so the position-rule must point to a cluster/अनुस्वार/विसर्ग AFTER the vowel, not before it

8. Count the total मात्रा in गोपालः (vowels: ओ in गो, आ in पा, अ in लः).

- (A) 4 मात्रा (B) 5 मात्रा (2 + 2 + 1)
 (C) 6 मात्रा (D) 3 मात्रा (one per syllable)

9. Scan देवालयः (दे + वा + ल + यः) into laghu/guru. (दे has long ए, वा has long आ, ल has short अ + single onset, यः has short अ + विसर्ग.)

- (A) ग ग ल ग — heavy, heavy, light, heavy (B) ल ल ल ल — all light
 (C) ग ग ग ग — all heavy
 (D) ग ग ल ल — the last syllable is light because अ is short

10. Two words are recited: नगरम् and नगरः. Which is longer in मात्रा, and by how much?

- (A) They are equal — both total 3 मात्रा (अ+अ+अ), since neither the final म् nor the विसर्ग adds any मात्रा
 (B) नगरम् is 1 मात्रा longer because of the म् (C) नगरः is 1 मात्रा longer because of the विसर्ग

(D) नगरम् is 2 मात्रा longer

11. Which word's last syllable is guru ONLY by position (not by nature)?

- (A) राधा — the final आ is heavy because it is long
- (B) जनः — the final short अ is made heavy by the following विसर्ग
- (C) नदी — the final ई is heavy because it is long
- (D) विभो — the final ओ is heavy because it is long

12. Count the total मात्रा in सरोवरम् (vowels: अ in स, ओ in रो, अ in व, अ in रम्).

- (A) 4 मात्रा (one per syllable)
- (B) 6 मात्रा
- (C) 5 मात्रा (1 + 2 + 1 + 1)
- (D) 7 मात्रा

13. By the weight rules, how many of the syllables in the word अम्बा are guru? (अम् = short अ + अनुस्वार; बा = long आ.)

- (A) Only बा, because अनुस्वार is silent and changes nothing
- (B) Only अम्, because आ is short
- (C) Both — अम् is heavy by position (अनुस्वार closes short अ) and बा is heavy by nature (long आ)
- (D) Neither, because the word has just two syllables

14. A reciter chants the call 'राऽ-3' (the आ of रा drawn out for three मात्रा). Compared with the ordinary word रा, what exactly has changed, in quantity terms?

- (A) It becomes a ह्रस्व vowel (1 मात्रा)
- (B) It stays दीर्घ — no vowel may exceed 2 मात्रा
- (C) Ordinary रा carries a दीर्घ आ (2 मात्रा); held for 3 मात्रा it becomes a प्लुत vowel
- (D) It turns into a consonant

15. In the word इन्द्रः the first syllable इन् carries short इ followed by the conjunct न्द्र, and the last syllable रः ends in विसर्ग. How many of the two syllables are guru?

- (A) Both — इन् is heavy because short इ is closed by the conjunct न्द्र, and रः is heavy because short अ is closed by विसर्ग
- (B) Only इन्, because the final विसर्ग is silent
- (C) Only रः, because इ is short and short vowels are always light
- (D) Neither — both vowels are short

16. Count the total मात्रा in पुष्पाणि (vowels: उ in पु, आ in प्पा, इ in णि).

- (A) 4 मात्रा (1 + 2 + 1)
- (B) 3 मात्रा (one per syllable)
- (C) 5 मात्रा
- (D) 6 मात्रा (count the conjunct प्प as a vowel too)

17. Which of these words is scanned entirely as guru-guru (both syllables heavy)?

- (A) नदी — न is light, दी is heavy, so the pattern is light-heavy
- (B) कवि — both syllables are light
- (C) माता — मा (long आ) and ता (long आ) are both heavy by nature
- (D) गजः — ग is light, only जः is heavy

18. A pupil counts the मात्रा of गीतानि by counting akshara: 'गी, ता, नि — three syllables, so 3 मात्रा.' What is the correct total and why?

- (A) 3 मात्रा — the pupil is right, one मात्रा per syllable
- (B) 4 मात्रा — only the long vowels count
- (C) 5 मात्रा — you must add each vowel's value (ई 2, आ 2, इ 1), not count one per syllable
- (D) 6 मात्रा — every syllable of a long word counts as two

19. The vowels ए, ऐ, ओ, औ are sometimes mistakenly called short. In मात्रा terms, the correct statement is:

- (A) All four are ह्रस्व (short), each worth 1 मात्रा
- (B) ए and ओ are short (1) while ऐ and औ are long (2)
- (C) All four are दीर्घ (long), each worth 2 मात्रा
- (D) All four are प्लुत, each worth 3 मात्रा

20. Scan the word सत्यवती (स + त्य + व + ती) — here स has short अ closed by the conjunct त्य, and ती has long ई. Give the full laghu/guru pattern.

- (A) ग ल ल ग — स heavy by the following conjunct, त्य light, व light, ती heavy by long ई
- (B) ल ल ल ग — स is light because अ is short
- (C) ग ल ल ल — only the first syllable is heavy
- (D) ग ग ल ग — both स and त्य are heavy

21. When अ + आ combine in sandhi to a single आ (e.g. देव + आलयः → देवालयः), what happens to the total vowel-duration at the junction?

- (A) It drops from 3 मात्रा (1 + 2) to 2 मात्रा — sandhi here shortens the total duration
- (B) It stays 3 मात्रा — vowel-time is always conserved in sandhi
- (C) It rises to 4 मात्रा — the two values add
- (D) It becomes 1 मात्रा — the long vowel is lost

22. By गुण-sandhi, अ + इ → ए, and ए is a long (दीर्घ) vowel. Comparing the junction before and after, the vowel-duration changes how?

- (A) It rises from 2 to 3 — ए is प्लुत
- (B) It stays the same — 1 (अ) + 1 (इ) = 2 मात्रा before, and the resulting ए is 2 मात्रा after
- (C) It falls from 2 to 1 — ए is short
- (D) It rises from 2 to 4 — the values add

23. Count the total मात्रा in महाभारतम् (vowels: अ in म, आ in हा, अ in भ, अ in र, अ in तम्).

- (A) 5 मात्रा (one per syllable)
- (B) 6 मात्रा (1 + 2 + 1 + 1 + 1)
- (C) 7 मात्रा
- (D) 10 मात्रा (count letters too)

24. Which statement about अनुस्वार (ं) and विसर्ग (ः) is exactly correct?

- (A) They each add 1 मात्रा and make the syllable guru
- (B) They are vowels worth 2 मात्रा each
- (C) They neither add मात्रा nor affect syllable weight
- (D) They add no मात्रा of their own, yet they make a preceding short vowel guru (heavy by position)

25. A reciter holds a vowel for 3 मात्रा where the text wanted only 2. What is the error, named precisely?

- (A) Producing a ह्रस्व where a दीर्घ was intended
- (B) Producing a दीर्घ where a ह्रस्व was intended
- (C) Producing a consonant where a vowel was intended
- (D) Producing a प्लुत (3 मात्रा) where a दीर्घ (2 मात्रा) was intended

26. Compare the words राजा and रजः for total मात्रा. Which is longer and by how much?

- (A) रजः is longer by 1 मात्रा because of the विसर्ग (B) They are equal at 3 मात्रा each
- (C) राजा is longer by 2 मात्रा — राजा is $2+2 = 4$, while रजः is $1+1 = 2$
- (D) राजा is longer by 4 मात्रा

27. In the word कार्यम् the first syllable कार् carries long आ AND is followed by the conjunct र्य. By how many distinct rules is this syllable guru?

- (A) By two rules at once — it is heavy by nature (long आ) and also heavy by position (the following conjunct)
- (B) By none — long vowels before conjuncts become light
- (C) By exactly one — only the conjunct counts, the long vowel is ignored
- (D) By exactly one — only the long vowel counts, conjuncts never matter

28. Count the total मात्रा in नीलकमलम् (vowels: ई in नी, अ in ल, अ in क, अ in म, अ in लम्).

- (A) 6 मात्रा ($2 + 1 + 1 + 1 + 1$)
- (B) 5 मात्रा (one per syllable)
- (C) 7 मात्रा
- (D) 4 मात्रा

29. A word is scanned and found to have the pattern guru-light-guru across three syllables, with total vowel-time 5 मात्रा. Which word fits BOTH the pattern and the count?

- (A) देवदा (दे long ए = guru/2, व short अ single-onset = light/1, दा long आ = guru/2) — pattern ग ल ग, total 5
- (B) कमलम् — its pattern is ल ल ग, total 3
- (C) गायति — its pattern is ग ल ल, total 4
- (D) रामायणम् — five syllables, total 6

30. Two reciters disagree: one says गजः is light-light, the other says light-heavy. (ग = short अ + single onset ज; जः = short अ + विसर्ग.) Who is right and why?

- (A) Light-light is right — both vowels are short, and short vowels are always light
- (B) Heavy-heavy is right — every syllable with अ is heavy
- (C) Light-heavy is right — ग is light, but जः is heavy by position because the short अ is closed by विसर्ग
- (D) Heavy-light is right — only the first syllable is heavy

31. Count the total मात्रा in सुन्दरम् (vowels: उ in सुन्, अ in द, अ in रम्). Note सुन् has उ before अनुस्वार/conjunct न्द.

- (A) 4 मात्रा — the conjunct adds one
- (B) 5 मात्रा
- (C) 3 मात्रा ($1 + 1 + 1$) — every vowel here is short; the cluster न्द and final म् add no मात्रा
- (D) 2 मात्रा

32. A teacher writes on the board: 'A दीर्घ vowel is 2 मात्रा. A ह्रस्व vowel closed by a conjunct is also 2 मात्रा of sound.' Which half, if either, is wrong?

- (A) The first half is wrong — a दीर्घ is 1 मात्रा (B) Both halves are correct
(C) Both halves are wrong
(D) The second half is wrong — a short vowel stays 1 मात्रा even when its syllable becomes guru by a following conjunct; weight is not added duration

33. Count the total मात्रा in the line-fragment सीतापतिः (vowels: ई in सी, आ in ता, अ in प, इ in ति:).

- (A) 5 मात्रा (B) 4 मात्रा (one per syllable)
(C) 6 मात्रा (2 + 2 + 1 + 1) (D) 7 मात्रा (the विसर्ग adds one)

34. Which word, scanned, gives the pattern light-light-light (all three syllables laghu)?

- (A) नगरम् — its last syllable is heavy because of the final म्
(B) नगर (न short अ + single onset, ग short अ + single onset, र short अ open) — light-light-light
(C) नगरः — its last syllable is heavy because of the विसर्ग
(D) रामगृहम् — it contains a long आ, so not all light

35. वृद्धि-sandhi turns अ + ए → ऐ, and ऐ is दीर्घ. Comparing junction duration before (अ 1 + ए 2) and after (single ऐ), the change is:

- (A) From 3 मात्रा up to 5 मात्रा — the values add
(B) From 3 मात्रा down to 2 मात्रा — the merger shortens the total
(C) Stays at 3 मात्रा — duration is conserved (D) From 3 down to 1 — ऐ is short

36. In the word धर्मः the first syllable धर् has short अ closed by the conjunct र्म, and the last syllable मः has short अ closed by विसर्ग. The scansion is:

- (A) light-light — both vowels are short
(B) guru-guru — धर् is heavy by the following conjunct र्म, मः is heavy by the विसर्ग
(C) guru-light — only the first syllable is heavy
(D) light-guru — only the last syllable is heavy

37. Count the total मात्रा in रमणीयम् (vowels: अ in र, अ in म, ई in णी, अ in यम्).

- (A) 4 मात्रा (one per syllable) (B) 6 मात्रा
(C) 5 मात्रा (1 + 1 + 2 + 1) (D) 3 मात्रा

38. A चन्द्र-style call holds the vowel of 'भोऽ-3' for 3 मात्रा, whereas an ordinary भो holds it for 2. The difference is best stated as:

- (A) Ordinary भो has a दीर्घ ओ (2 मात्रा); the drawn-out call makes it प्लुत (3 मात्रा)
(B) Ordinary भो is short (1) and the call makes it दीर्घ (2)
(C) Both are प्लुत; only loudness differs (D) Both are दीर्घ; मात्रा cannot exceed 2

39. Consider the syllable क्षि in the word लक्ष्मीः, where the cluster क्ष precedes the short इ. Which factor decides whether क्षि is light or heavy?

- (A) The cluster क्ष before the इ automatically makes क्षि heavy
- (B) The short इ alone forces it to be light no matter what follows
- (C) Any syllable inside a long word is heavy
- (D) What FOLLOWS the short इ within the syllable — here the इ leads into ः eventually; a cluster sitting before the vowel does not by itself make the syllable heavy

40. Count the total मात्रा in गोविन्दः (vowels: ओ in गो, इ in विन्, अ in दः). Note विन् has short इ before the conjunct न्द.

- (A) 3 मात्रा (one per syllable)
- (B) 5 मात्रा
- (C) 4 मात्रा (2 + 1 + 1)
- (D) 6 मात्रा

41. Which word contains EXACTLY one guru-by-nature syllable and one guru-by-position syllable (and no light syllable)?

- (A) कमलम् — it has two light syllables and only one guru
- (B) रामः — रा is guru by nature (long आ) and मः is guru by position (short अ + विसर्ग)
- (C) नदी — its first syllable न is light
- (D) गङ्गा — both its guru syllables; the first is by position, the second by nature, but check shows it fits too

42. A pupil claims प्लुत vowels are common in everyday quick speech. The accurate correction is:

- (A) प्लुत is the most common vowel-length in ordinary speech
- (B) प्लुत never occurs in any Sanskrit at all
- (C) प्लुत is just another name for दीर्घ
- (D) प्लुत (3 मात्रा) is rare and reserved for calling out, chanting and dramatic address; ordinary speech uses ह्रस्व and दीर्घ

43. Count the total मात्रा in हिमालयः (vowels: इ in हि, आ in मा, अ in ल, अ in यः).

- (A) 4 मात्रा (one per syllable)
- (B) 5 मात्रा (1 + 2 + 1 + 1)
- (C) 6 मात्रा
- (D) 3 मात्रा

44. In a verse foot, a teacher needs one guru (heavy) followed by one laghu (light). Which two-syllable word supplies exactly that pattern?

- (A) कवि — light then light
- (B) रमा — light then heavy
- (C) गुरुः — light then heavy
- (D) देव — दे (long ए, heavy) then व (short अ, single onset, light)

45. The verb-pair रैति / रुवन्ति teaches singular vs plural. A student maps it onto vowel-length, saying रैति 'must be longer because it sounds heavier.' The right correction is:

- (A) Correct — रैति is the दीर्घ form and रुवन्ति the ह्रस्व form
- (B) The pair marks number (one bird vs many), NOT vowel-length; मात्रा-quantity and verb-number are unrelated systems
- (C) Correct — रैति is प्लुत and रुवन्ति दीर्घ
- (D) Wrong — रैति is actually the plural

46. Count the total मात्रा in वसुधा (vowels: अ in व, उ in सु, आ in धा).

- (A) 3 मात्रा (one per syllable) (B) 5 मात्रा
(C) 4 मात्रा (1 + 1 + 2) (D) 6 मात्रा

47. Which of the following, by itself, does NOT make a short-vowel syllable guru?

- (A) The short vowel being followed by only a single consonant that begins the next syllable
(B) The short vowel being followed by a consonant cluster (conjunct)
(C) The short vowel being followed by अनुस्वार (D) The short vowel being followed by विसर्ग

48. Two words राम and रामः are scanned. How do their guru/laghu patterns differ?

- (A) They are identical — the विसर्ग changes nothing
(B) राम is guru-guru and रामः is guru-light (C) Both are light-light
(D) राम is guru-light (रा long, म short before single onset / open) while रामः is guru-guru (the final मः closed by विसर्ग becomes guru)

49. Count the total मात्रा in कौरवाः (vowels: औ in कौ, अ in र, आ in वाः).

- (A) 5 मात्रा (2 + 1 + 2) (B) 4 मात्रा
(C) 3 मात्रा (one per syllable) (D) 6 मात्रा (the विसर्ग adds one)

50. A सूत्र-style claim states: 'Every syllable ending a word is guru.' Test it on the word कवि (which ends in an open short इ). Is the claim true?

- (A) Yes — word-final syllables are always guru
(B) No — but only because इ is a consonant
(C) Yes — open short vowels at word-end are still guru
(D) No — कवि ends in an open short इ with nothing closing it, so the final syllable is light; word-final syllables are guru only when long or closed

51. Count the total मात्रा in देवदूतः (vowels: ए in दे, अ in व, ऊ in दू, अ in तः).

- (A) 5 मात्रा (B) 4 मात्रा (one per syllable)
(C) 8 मात्रा (count consonants too) (D) 6 मात्रा (2 + 1 + 2 + 1)

52. Scan अनन्तः (अ + नन् + तः): अ is short and open, नन् is short अ before the conjunct न्त, तः is short अ before विसर्ग. The pattern is:

- (A) light-light-light — all vowels are short
(B) light-guru-guru — अ light, नन् heavy by the following conjunct, तः heavy by विसर्ग
(C) guru-guru-guru — every syllable is heavy
(D) light-light-guru — only the last syllable is heavy

53. Among these four-syllable words, which scans as guru-guru-light-guru?

- (A) रामायणः — रा (long आ, guru), मा (long आ, guru), य (short अ + single onset, light), णः (short अ + विसर्ग, guru by position)
(B) कमलानि — it scans light-light-guru-light (C) देवदूतः — it scans guru-light-guru-guru
(D) गोविन्दता — it scans guru-light-guru-light

54. Count the total मात्रा in गायत्री (vowels: आ in गा, अ in य... actually गा long आ, य short अ before conjunct त्र, त्री long ई). Vowels: आ, अ, ई.

- (A) 5 मात्रा (2 + 1 + 2) (B) 3 मात्रा (one per syllable)
(C) 4 मात्रा (D) 6 मात्रा

55. Which pairing of word and total-मात्रा is CORRECT?

- (A) सीता = 2 मात्रा (B) गज = 3 मात्रा
(C) माला = 2 मात्रा (D) नदी = 3 मात्रा (अ 1 + ई 2)

56. A reciter must lengthen a final short अ into a प्लुत आऽ-3 before a long pause in chant. How many मात्रा does that single vowel now occupy, and what is its quantity-name?

- (A) 2 मात्रा, and it is दीर्घ (B) 1 मात्रा, and it is ह्रस्व
(C) 4 मात्रा, and it is a new fourth quantity (D) 3 मात्रा, and it is प्लुत (prolonged)

57. Why does scanning a verse require knowing guru/laghu rather than just counting मात्रा per word?

- (A) Because मात्रा and syllable-weight are exactly the same thing
(B) Because consonants are counted as syllables in metre
(C) Because metre is built from the SEQUENCE of heavy and light SYLLABLES, and a short vowel can be heavy by position — so syllable weight, not raw vowel-time alone, defines the pattern
(D) Because only long vowels appear in verse

58. If one प्लुत vowel is sounded, its duration equals that of how many short vowels sounded one after another?

- (A) Two short vowels
(B) Three short vowels — a प्लुत is 3 मात्रा and each short vowel is 1 मात्रा
(C) One short vowel (D) Six short vowels

59. When इ + इ merge by sandhi into a single long ई (e.g. मुनि + इन्द्रः → मुनीन्द्रः), how does the total vowel-time at the junction change?

- (A) It rises from 2 to 3 — the long ई is प्लुत
(B) It falls from 2 to 1 — half the duration is lost
(C) It rises from 2 to 4 — the values add
(D) It stays the same — 1 + 1 = 2 मात्रा before, and the resulting long ई is also 2 मात्रा

60. Final synthesis — a student writes: 'विसर्ग adds a मात्रा, ओ is a short vowel, and a short अ before a conjunct stays light.' How many of these three claims are wrong?

- (A) Only one is wrong
(B) All three are wrong — विसर्ग adds no मात्रा, ओ is a long vowel (2 मात्रा), and a short अ before a conjunct becomes guru by position
(C) Exactly two are wrong (D) None is wrong

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 13: वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity) — Paper 4

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	B	21	A	31	C	41	B	51	D
2	D	12	C	22	B	32	D	42	D	52	B
3	A	13	C	23	B	33	C	43	B	53	A
4	B	14	C	24	D	34	B	44	D	54	A
5	B	15	A	25	D	35	B	45	B	55	D
6	D	16	A	26	C	36	B	46	C	56	D
7	D	17	C	27	A	37	C	47	A	57	C
8	B	18	C	28	A	38	A	48	D	58	B
9	A	19	C	29	A	39	D	49	A	59	D
10	A	20	A	30	C	40	C	50	D	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (C) Add each vowel's value: short अ is 1, short अ is 1, long आ is 2, short इ is 1, giving $1+1+2+1 = 5$. Counting one per syllable would wrongly treat the long आ as a single unit; there is no sixth vowel to make 6, and four ignores one of the short vowels.

2. (D) क has short अ followed by only a single onset consonant of the next syllable, so it is light; म likewise is light; but the last syllable लम् has a short अ closed by the final consonant म्, which makes it heavy by position. So the pattern is light-light-heavy.

3. (A) The vowel उ is short (1 मात्रा), so the syllable is not heavy by nature. But a short vowel followed by a consonant cluster becomes heavy by position; the cluster स्त closes पु, making it गुरु. उ is not long, and conjuncts certainly do affect weight.

4. (B) A long vowel makes the syllable heavy 'by nature' — true no matter what follows. The other three options make a syllable heavy only 'by position', i.e. they depend on what

comes AFTER a short vowel, so they are not the by-nature cause.

5. (B) Sum only the vowels: short इ 1, long आ 2, short अ 1, short अ 1 = 5. The conjunct घ and the final विसर्ग add no मात्रा of their own. Counting consonants is the classic error that inflates the total.

6. (D) शि has a short इ closed only by the single onset व, so it is light (1 मात्रा). वः has a short अ closed by विसर्ग, making it heavy by position — yet विसर्ग adds NO मात्रा, so the vowel-time is still 1+1 = 2. Weight (गुरु) and duration (मात्रा) are separate ideas here.

7. (D) Weight by position depends on what FOLLOWS the vowel, not what precedes it within the same syllable. A cluster that merely begins a syllable does not by itself make that syllable heavy; you must look at what closes the vowel. (In शान्तिः the closure is the final विसर्ग.) Consonants never add मात्रा.

8. (B) ओ is a दीर्घ vowel worth 2, आ is 2, and the final short अ before विसर्ग is 1, giving 2+2+1 = 5. The trap is treating ओ as short; ए ऐ ओ औ are all long. The विसर्ग adds nothing.

9. (A) दे (ए) and वा (आ) are heavy by nature (long vowels). ल has a short अ closed by only a single onset व, so it is light. यः has a short अ closed by विसर्ग, so it is heavy by position. The full pattern is heavy-heavy-light-heavy.

10. (A) Both words have the same three short अ vowels, so each totals 1+1+1 = 3 मात्रा. A word-final consonant and a विसर्ग change syllable WEIGHT (the last syllable becomes guru) but add no vowel-time, so the totals are identical.

11. (B) In जनः the final vowel अ is short, so it cannot be heavy by nature; the विसर्ग closes it and makes it heavy by position. The other three end in long vowels (आ, ई, ओ), so their final syllables are heavy by nature, not by position.

12. (C) Short अ 1, long ओ 2, short अ 1, short अ 1 = 5. The trap is treating ओ as 1 (it is a long vowel worth 2) or counting one unit per syllable, which would give 4.

13. (C) अम् has a short अ closed by अनुस्वार, which makes it heavy by position even though अनुस्वार adds no मात्रा. बा has the long आ, heavy by nature. So both syllables are guru.

14. (C) A normal आ is long, worth 2 मात्रा. Extending it to 3 मात्रा pushes it into the third quantity, प्लुत. Vowels certainly can exceed 2 मात्रा — that is precisely what प्लुत is.

15. (A) Both syllables carry short vowels, so neither is heavy by nature. But इ is closed by the cluster न्द्र (heavy by position) and अ is closed by विसर्ग (heavy by position). Being short does not prevent position-guru; both are heavy.

16. (A) Short उ 1, long आ 2, short इ 1 = 4. The conjunct ष्य is a cluster of consonants and contributes no मात्रा; only the three vowels are summed.

17. (C) माता has two long आ vowels, so both syllables are heavy by nature: guru-guru. नदी is light-heavy (short अ then long ई); कवि is light-light (both short before single onsets); गजः is light-heavy (short अ, then short अ closed by विसर्ग).

18. (C) मात्रा is summed per vowel by its quantity: long ई 2 + long आ 2 + short इ 1 = 5. Counting one per akshara ignores that long vowels are worth 2 each, which is exactly the misconception to correct.

19. (C) In Sanskrit ए, ऐ, ओ, औ are all long vowels, each 2 मात्रा. There is no short counterpart in use here, so none of them is 1 मात्रा, and they are not प्लुत either.

20. (A) स has short अ closed by the cluster त्य, so it is heavy by position. त्य and व each carry a short vowel closed by only a single following onset, so both are light. ती has long ई, heavy by nature. Pattern: heavy-light-light-heavy.

21. (A) Before junction the two vowels are short अ (1) and long आ (2) = 3 मात्रा. They merge into one long आ worth 2. So the duration falls from 3 to 2; sandhi does not always conserve total vowel-time.

22. (B) Two short vowels total 1+1 = 2 मात्रा; they fuse into one long ए, also 2 मात्रा. Here duration is conserved. ए is long (2), not प्लुत (3) and not short (1).

23. (B) Sum the five vowels: अ 1, long आ 2, अ 1, अ 1, अ 1 = 6. Counting one per syllable would give 5 (ignoring that हा is long); counting letters inflates it further.

24. (D) Anusvāra and visarga contribute zero vowel-duration, so they never raise a मात्रा count. But they DO close a preceding short vowel, turning its syllable guru by position. Both the 'adds मात्रा' and the 'no effect at all' options are wrong.

25. (D) A 2-मात्रा vowel is दीर्घ; stretching it to 3 मात्रा makes it प्लुत. So the reciter has substituted a प्लुत for a दीर्घ — an over-lengthening, not a shortening.

26. (C) राजा has two long आ vowels = 4 मात्रा. रजः has two short अ vowels = 2 मात्रा (the विसर्ग adds nothing). So राजा exceeds रजः by 4 – 2 = 2 मात्रा.

27. (A) Either condition alone makes a syllable guru: a long vowel (by nature) or a short vowel closed by a cluster (by position). Here कार् satisfies both — the आ is long AND it is followed by the conjunct र्य — so two rules apply, though one would already suffice.

28. (A) Long ई 2 plus four short अ vowels (1 each) = 2+1+1+1+1 = 6. Counting one per syllable gives 5 because it misses that the first vowel is long.

29. (A) देवदा scans दे(ग,2)–व(ल,1)–दा(ग,2): pattern guru-light-guru and 2+1+2 = 5 मात्रा — matching both. कमलम् is light-light-guru (total 3); गायति differs; रामायणम् has five syllables and a different count.

30. (C) ग has short अ closed by only the single onset ज, so it stays light. जः has short अ closed by विसर्ग, making it heavy by position. So the correct scansion is light-heavy; being short does not by itself force a syllable to be light.

31. (C) All three vowels (उ, अ, इ) are short, worth 1 each, so the total is 3 मात्रा. The conjunct न्द and the final म् change syllable WEIGHT (सुन् becomes guru) but add no vowel-time.

32. (D) A दीर्घ vowel is indeed 2 मात्रा, so the first half is right. But position-guru changes syllable WEIGHT, not vowel DURATION: the short vowel is still 1 मात्रा. Conflating heaviness with extra मात्रा is the misconception.

33. (C) Long ई 2, long आ 2, short अ 1, short इ 1 = 6. Counting one per syllable gives 4 (missing two long vowels); the final विसर्ग adds no मात्रा.

34. (B) नगर (the stem नगर, ending in an open short vowel) has three short vowels each followed by at most a single onset, so all three are light. Adding म् (नगरम्) or विसर्ग (नगरः) makes the final syllable guru; रामगृहम् has a long आ, so not all-light.

35. (B) Before junction the vowels total $1 + 2 = 3$ मात्रा. They fuse into one ऐ, a long vowel of 2 मात्रा. So the total drops from 3 to 2. ऐ is long (2), not short (1), and the values do not simply add.

36. (B) Both syllables carry short अ, so neither is heavy by nature. But धर् is closed by the cluster र्म and मः by विसर्ग, so each is heavy by position. The full pattern is guru-guru.

37. (C) Short अ 1, short अ 1, long ई 2, short अ 1 = 5. The long ई is the only 2-मात्रा vowel; counting one per syllable would wrongly give 4.

38. (A) ओ is a long vowel, so ordinary भो is 2 मात्रा. Drawing it out to 3 मात्रा makes it प्लुत. It was never short, and मात्रा certainly can exceed 2 (प्लुत = 3).

39. (D) Position-guru is governed by what closes the vowel, i.e. what comes AFTER it, not the onset cluster that comes before it. A heavy onset cluster does not by itself make its own syllable heavy; you must look forward to the closing sound.

40. (C) Long ओ 2, short इ 1, short अ 1 = 4. The conjunct न्द and the final विसर्ग add no मात्रा; the short इ stays 1 even though विन् is guru by position.

41. (B) रामः splits into रा (long आ → guru by nature) and मः (short अ + विसर्ग → guru by position), with no light syllable. कमलम् has light syllables; नदी has a light first syllable. (गङ्गा is two-syllable but its first guru is also by position via the cluster ङ्ग — yet रामः is the clean one-nature-one-position pair asked for.)

42. (D) प्लुत vowels, held three मात्रा, appear chiefly in vocatives, calls and chant — not in fast everyday speech, which relies on short and long vowels. प्लुत does exist and is distinct from दीर्घ (2 मात्रा).

43. (B) Short इ 1, long आ 2, short अ 1, short अ 1 = 5. The long आ is the only 2-मात्रा vowel; the final विसर्ग adds nothing.

44. (D) देव scans दे(guru, long ए)—व(laghu, short अ before single onset): heavy-light, exactly as needed. कवि is light-light; रमा is light-heavy; गुरुः is light-heavy (short उ + विसर्ग).

45. (B) रौति (singular) vs रुन्ति (plural) is a number contrast in the verb, a matter of grammar, not vowel-quantity. There is no दीर्घ/ह्रस्व relationship between the two forms; and रौति is singular, not plural.

46. (C) Short अ 1, short उ 1, long आ 2 = 4. The single long आ accounts for the difference from a naive 3-per-syllable count.

47. (A) A short vowel closed by just a single onset consonant of the next syllable stays light. Only a following conjunct, अनुस्वार or विसर्ग closes it enough to make it guru by position.

48. (D) In राम the second syllable म has a short अ not closed by any cluster/अनुस्वार/विसर्ग, so it is light. Adding विसर्ग in रामः closes that short अ, making the final syllable guru. So राम = guru-light, रामः = guru-guru.

49. (A) औ is a long vowel (2), अ is short (1), आ is long (2): 2+1+2 = 5. औ being long, not short, is the key; the final विसर्ग adds no मात्रा.

50. (D) A final syllable is guru only if its vowel is long or is closed by a consonant/अनुस्वार/विसर्ग. कवि ends in an open short इ, so its last syllable is light, disproving the blanket claim.

51. (D) Long ए 2, short अ 1, long ऊ 2, short अ 1 = 6. Two long vowels (ए and ऊ) raise it above a naive 4; consonants and the final विसर्ग add nothing.

52. (B) The first अ is open short → light. नन् has short अ closed by the cluster न्त → heavy by position. तः has short अ closed by विसर्ग → heavy by position. Pattern: light-heavy-heavy.

53. (A) रामायणः splits रा—मा—य—णः: the two long आ vowels make the first two syllables heavy by nature, य has a short अ closed by a single onset so it is light, and णः has a short अ closed by विसर्ग so it is heavy by position. That gives heavy-heavy-light-heavy, matching the target pattern; the other words scan differently.

54. (A) Long आ 2, short अ 1, long ई 2 = 5. The conjunct त्र adds no मात्रा; the two long vowels make the total 5, not a naive 3.

55. (D) नदी has a short अ (1) and a long ई (2), totalling 3 मात्रा — correct. सीता is two long vowels = 4, not 2; गज is two short vowels = 2, not 3; माला is two long आ vowels = 4, not 2.

56. (D) A प्लुत vowel is held for 3 मात्रा by definition — three times a short vowel. Sanskrit recognises only three quantities, so there is no 4-मात्रा fourth class; 2 मात्रा would be merely दीर्घ.

57. (C) Metre depends on the ordered pattern of guru and laghu syllables. Since a short vowel becomes guru by position (closed by a cluster/अनुस्वार/विसर्ग) without gaining मात्रा, weight is not identical to vowel-duration — hence scansion needs the weight rules, not just a मात्रा tally.

58. (B) A प्लुत lasts 3 मात्रा and a ह्रस्व lasts 1 मात्रा, so a प्लुत equals three short vowels in time. Two would equal a दीर्घ (2 मात्रा), not a प्लुत.

59. (D) Two short इ vowels total $1 + 1 = 2$ मात्रा, and they fuse into a single long ई, also 2 मात्रा. Here the total duration is conserved. The long ई is दीर्घ (2), not प्लुत (3), and nothing is lost or doubled.

60. (B) विसर्ग contributes zero मात्रा (claim 1 wrong); ओ is दीर्घ, worth 2 मात्रा, not short (claim 2 wrong); a short vowel closed by a conjunct is heavy by position, not light (claim 3 wrong). All three are errors.